

FAQ – Thesis- Master of Computer Science

What is the difference between Internship report/ general essays and Thesis?

Thesis work is completely scientific and is based on critically reviewed scientific work, while the other general essay works are not.

What are the pre-requisites for the Thesis module?

The student needs to ensure that there are no pending modules from the previous semesters to enroll for the Thesis. For a master's programme, A minimum of 80 credits needs to be recorded as complete to register for the Thesis. In exceptional circumstances, the Programme head can allow for the Thesis registration.

What are the forms relevant to the Thesis Module?

The Thesis proposal form, The Thesis registration form, and The Thesis report. When needed, The Deadline Extension form, and the Study Extension Form.

Is there a deadline for the first-draft submission?

There is no first draft. Only the final submission. Once you have officially registered for the Master thesis at the exam office (form on Moodle see question 1), the exam office will inform you of the deadline and submission date (16 weeks after registration). Therefore, you should register only if you are sure that you can finish your paper within 16 weeks.

What is the minimum length of the Thesis document?

The recommended length of the document is 30,000 words with Times New Roman font size 12 with 1,5 spacing. This does not include table of contents, graphs, annexures etc. The core content of research needs to be for the mentioned length. The length of the document can be discussed and agreed with the primary supervisor as this is subject to topic, methodology and other attributes.

What are the format requirements of the Thesis document?

Thesis documents need to have: Font Arial or Times New Roman , Normal, size 11 or 12, Spacing indent of 1,5 and 2 cm margin on all the sides.

Does the thesis need to be hard copy or just a soft copy?

One bound hardcopy of the Thesis work and a soft copy on a pen drive, with all cited documents, need to be submitted to the Examination Office by the deadline. Please refer to the email which

you will receive from the examination office when you have registered for the Thesis. The cover page, graphs and pictures need to be in colour and the rest of the text can be in Black and White.

Can the Thesis document be submitted by anyone else?

No.

Can the thesis document be sent by post?

The thesis document can be sent by post. But it is to be noted that the "posted on" date on the stamp needs to be on or before the submission date.

Are there any Thesis templates?

The standard template is available on eCampus – My Studies – Academic Materials – Materials for my studies and theses. It is recommended to use internet search to identify some samples of theses. You can also gain support from your supervisor/s.

Can we submit the Thesis before the deadline?

The processing time for the thesis is max 16 weeks. Of course it can be submitted earlier. However, it is recommended not to be in a hurry, as it counts as once attempted. The Examination Office does not accept early submissions which are too early. For example, eight weeks before the announced deadline. This is also based on the reason for early submission and the decision is made on a case-to-case basis. Please write to the Programme Coordinator and the Programme Head for further guidance, should such a situation arise.

Who needs to supervise my thesis?

There are two supervisors needed for Thesis. Primary and Secondary. **Primary** supervisor is the main while the **secondary** is support. At least one of them needs to be a professor. One supervisor needs to be from SRH University.

The other supervisor can be from outside SRH. When one of the supervisors is not from SRH, a corresponding resume needs to be shared with the examination board during the process of the registration.

What is the role of the supervisors in the Thesis work?

The responsibility of both the supervisors is only to **guide** the research efforts the students make. This means, that the supervisors do not review the thesis document before it is submitted. Once the document is submitted, it is considered as submitted, not submitted for review and feedback.

What is the role of the students in the Thesis work?

The student holds the most important role in the thesis. Thesis work is a representation of the research and learning efforts spent by the student. The student is the owner of the Thesis work and can take guidance from the supervisors.

Does the University by default provide a supervisor?

No. The SRH teaching staff and professors have different research interests and expertise. It is for the students to find a topic and identify supervisors who are willing to supervise such research efforts. At the same time, each teaching staff has a limit on how many Theses he or she can supervise. Hence, when the student's proposal has been rejected by a teacher/professor, the responsibility to find another teacher/professor lies on the students' shoulders. **In extreme circumstances, the student can write to the Programme Head for further guidance.**

Can more than 1 student write a thesis together?

Although more than 1 student can collaborate to write a research paper, this does not apply for the Thesis work. Thesis is a work of one individual student and not a collaborative effort with anyone else.

How do I choose a topic for Thesis?

It's helpful to choose a topic of your interest. It is advised to read a few scientific papers and or/books to choose a topic of interest. Discussions with your teacher/s are also recommended.

What is the procedure for submitting a Thesis proposal?

After identifying a topic, you need to find a primary supervisor who is willing to supervise your Thesis. A Thesis proposal form is submitted to the primary supervisor. Please refer to the Thesis Proposal template for more information.

What are the methods which I can choose for my research work or Thesis?

This is based on your topic and the discussion with your primary supervisor

Can I change the topic of my Thesis?

Once a thesis proposal is approved, it is advised not to change the thesis topic. However, if you choose to change the topic, this needs to be discussed with the primary supervisor. The deadlines will remain the same. If unable to complete the Thesis by the deadline, the Thesis can be submitted the next semester, by extending the study period.

Can I change my supervisors during my Thesis work?

Yes. One or both the supervisors can be changed during the thesis research. However, the changes need to be notified with a new registration form to the examination board, Programme coordinator and the Programme Head.

Can I perform a Thesis at the Organization I am working?

Yes. Some organizations offer Thesis support. You can also choose a secondary supervisor from your work. This needs to be notified and approved by the primary supervisor.

Do I need to provide any references from the company where I will be doing the thesis from?

Yes, if one of the supervisors is from the company (the other supervisor has to be a professor at our university). Formally, he or she must be appointed by the exam board. In practice, the head of the program will do it. For this he or she needs to provide a CV.

Who is responsible to give the grades for Thesis?

Both the primary and secondary supervisor together grade your thesis work and defense. The Thesis grading scheme is found on Campus – My Studies – Academic Materials – Materials for my studies and theses - Evaluation sheet for Bachelor and Master theses (BST)

How is the Thesis work graded?

The thesis module is graded with 80% weightage to the thesis research work and 20 % to the Defense presentation. The grading is provided based on the content, effectiveness, plagiarism, language, and all attributes which are required for scientific work. Please refer to the grading system from the EO on campusnet.

What are the consequences of failing a Master Thesis work?

When a student fails to complete a Master thesis work due to poor grades, he or she needs to repeat the module. This means the procedure for Thesis registration needs to be repeated. The supervisors can remain the same, however, the topic needs to be changed.

What is defense presentation?

This is a presentation of your research work. The mode, date and duration of this presentation is an agreement between the student and the two supervisors.

When do I make my defense presentation?

This is based on the availability of the primary and secondary supervisor. Hence, you need to make a request to complete your defense. The defense presentation needs to be before the end of the semester.

What do I do if I want to extend my thesis deadline?

Thesis deadline can be extended with sufficient notice. The request must be made at the earliest. The deadline extension request form needs to be filled, approved by the SRH supervisor and the programmed head. This approved form needs to be sent to the coordinator and the examination board. The examination board (Prof. Klaus Neumann) gives the final approval. There must be sufficient documentation the reasons for the extension, and at the BST only the examination board can approve the application for an extension of the master's thesis processing time. This form must be sent to Prof. Neumann for approval. Because they do not know who sits on the examination board and who is the head of the examination board.

Do we need to pay any fee for Thesis deadline extension?

No. Remember thesis deadline extension and study extension are different. If the deadline extension leads to a study extension, fees could be applicable. Please refer to the study extension form on eCampus – My Studies – Forms.

I already manage an internship/working student job/full time job. Will this be considered while grading my thesis work?

No. Thesis work is a representation of the student's learning and research efforts. Hence, other attributes will not be considered while grading the Thesis work. It is advised that the students plan their research efforts well in advance so that they can complete their research and documentation successfully.

Can I choose the same topic for Internship and Thesis?

No.

Can I register for two Theses at the same time?

No.

What do I do, if I have a personal emergency or unforeseen circumstance or health issues during my Thesis period?

Due to any reason if the student is unable to continue the research efforts as planned, the supervisors, Programme head, examination board and the Programme coordinators need to be

informed as early as possible. Additional documents (e.g Doctor's certificate) need to be submitted along with the request for Thesis extension request form, as an evidence to the circumstance detailed by the student.

Can I change my Master Thesis topic, once I have started with it?

Yes. If the student intends to make a change to the topic once a Thesis work is registered, he or she can do that.

- If the topic changes and both the supervisors remain the same: A new thesis proposal, registration form needs to be submitted to the examination board, after the programme head, coordinator have been informed or marked on the email.
- If the topic and the supervisors change: The previous supervisors need to be naturally informed that the student will not continue to work with them.

The student needs to remember that if the second proposal is accepted mid semester, the research work may cause extension into the next semester. Hence, the student needs to bear the fees for the following semester.

Can I check for Plagiarism Online?

There is no recommended solution for to avoid Plagiarism issues which may arise during the research work. It is critical to pay attention to necessary citation where needed to avoid Plagiarism. The software used by the university is a professional edition and performs much accurately than the ones which may be available on the internet.

What is the acceptable plagiarism rate at SRH?

SRH does not accept plagiarism any more than 5%. High levels of Plagiarism could lead to Exmatriculation.

What will happen if I fail my Thesis Module?

The total number of attempts the student gets to complete this module is 3. Post which, the student will be ex-matriculated and may not be able to complete this module from any University in Germany. Do note that tuition fees for the module may apply when the student needs to reattempt the module.

What do I do if I am not convinced with the grade received?

Every student has the access to setup a meeting with both supervisors to get an explanation of the Thesis' grade. When not convinced, the student can set up a meeting with the supervisors and the examination board.

Sequence of submitting a Thesis Work

Identify a topic of interest and prepare, identify a specific research question

Identify two supervisors. One of them needs to be an SRH Professor.

Meet both the supervisors and get approval that if they can supervise your thesis.

Fill the thesis proposal template and submit it to the supervisors and get their approval-signature

Submit the research proposal along with thesis registration form to the examination board. Coordinator on cc

You receive a deadline from the examination board for the thesis work

Submit the thesis report as per deadline and block a date for defense presentation